

PART A: RCTFCE PROMPT

Role:

Act as a senior retail analytics expert with 15+ years experience.

Context:

A retail company operates 30 stores and has experienced declining performance over the last 18 months. The company has provided approximately 50,000 records covering store performance, product sales, customer transactions, and loyalty programme activity. The CEO wants to understand the causes of the decline and identify opportunities for improvement.

Task:

Generate 5 SMART business questions that can help me to create a stakeholder brief for the CEO. Identify the most important business questions, explain how the available data can be used to answer them, and highlight decisions that the findings will support.

Format:

Present the output as a professional one-page stakeholder brief with the following sections:

1. Situation Summary
2. Three Key Business Questions
3. Decisions These Questions Will Inform
4. Description of Available Data
5. Recommended Next Steps

Constraints:

- Maximum 250 words
- Use clear business language suitable for the CEO
- Focus only on information supported by the available data
- Avoid technical jargon and statistical details
- Highlight results in bullet points where appropriate

Example:

Business Question: "Are sales declines concentrated in specific stores, regions, or product categories?"

Decision Informed: "Whether to restructure store operations, reallocate resources, or consider store closures in specific locations."

PART B: Stakeholder Brief

Situation Summary

The company has experienced declining performance across its 30-store network over the last 18 months. A review of store performance, product sales, customer transactions, and loyalty programme data is required to determine the drivers of the decline and identify opportunities for growth and operational improvement.

Three Key Business Questions

1. Which stores, product categories, or regions are contributing most to the performance decline?
2. Have customer purchasing patterns, transaction frequency, or average spending changed over time?
3. How effective is the loyalty programme in retaining customers and driving repeat purchases?

Decisions These Questions Will Inform

- Resource allocation to underperforming stores.
- Product assortment, pricing, and promotional strategies.
- Customer retention and loyalty programme improvements.
- Future investment priorities and growth initiatives.

Description of Available Data

- Store performance metrics across 30 locations.
- Product sales records showing category and item-level performance.
- Customer transaction data including purchase frequency and spending patterns.
- Loyalty programme activity covering membership engagement and repeat purchases.

Recommended Next Steps

Conduct trend, store-level, product-level, and customer behaviour analyses to identify root causes of declining performance and develop targeted improvement actions.

REFLECTION: I structured the prompt using the RCTFCE framework to provide clear guidance on the AI's role, objectives, and expected output. The constraints ensure the response remains executive-focused and concise, while the example helps the AI understand the level of detail and business relevance expected in the final stakeholder brief.